

Introduction

Without going into a vi vs Emacs style debate at the very beginning, we'd like to state that it is an accepted opinion that GNU/Linux is a very decent choice for running your web / application servers. If they're better than Windows, we'll leave it up to you to decide. With the brilliant work done by organisations such as Red Hat and Canonical (Ubuntu's parent Organisation), Linux is being adopted on the desktop at a massive rate and not just in enterprise/scientific research environment, but by home users looking for safe and stable operating systems. This makes managing Linux-based systems an essential skill.

If you have multiple GNU/Linux-based systems on a common local network, you can use this guide to streamline their maintenance. You'll learn concepts such as centralisation and remote management among st others. It's important to understand that a Linux administrator is just a normal user with extended privileges in terms of file permission and is slightly more ninja with the command line than you are. Don't get intimidated by the term "Linux Administrator", if you've been using Linux for some time, you're already half way there.

This guide is designed as an introduction to basic Linux administration aimed especially towards home users and small system managers. Therefore, we have included tutorials on setting up media servers rather than having an LDAP authentication server.

There are appendices included with this guide that are independent of other chapters. We strongly recommended you to familiarise yourself with various terminologies by reading the appendices before other chapters. We have tried to focus on making this guide as applicable as possible, we have introduced you to setting a up and running an Apache web server, so that you can run a local web site for your place, or if your size escalates you can even have your own dedicated web server.

In order to utilise this guide to the maximum, it is strongly recommended to replicate the steps/commands mentioned here on a Linux system, a handy tip at this time would be that of virtual